

# Menstral Plus

Film Coated Tablets



## Composition:

Each Menstral Plus Film Coated Tablet contains:

Mefenamic acid 250 mg and Drotaverine HCl 80 mg.

## Mechanism of Action:

Menstral Plus is a potent analgesic combination of drotaverine and mefenamic acid. Menstral Plus effectively treats muscular spasms, abdominal pains and cramps accompanying menstrual.

Mefenamic acid is a non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drug (NSAID) with anti-inflammatory, analgesic and antipyretic effects. It works by preventing the synthesis of prostaglandins, by inhibiting the cyclooxygenase pathway.

Drotaverine is a selective inhibitor of phosphodiesterase-4 (PDE-4), which is an enzyme responsible for the degradation of cyclic adenosine monophosphate (cAMP). Inhibition of phosphodiesterase-4 leads to elevated levels of cAMP, leading to smooth muscle relaxation.

## Pharmacokinetics:

Mefenamic acid is absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract. Peak plasma concentrations are 10 mg/L in adult patients 2 hours after a 1 g oral dose administration. It is mainly metabolized by the cytochrome P450 enzyme (CYP2C9) in the liver. Metabolites undergo secondary conjugation to form glucuronides. Mefenamic acid has a half-life of approximately two hours. 52% of a dose is recovered in the urine (6% as mefenamic acid, 46% as metabolites). Approximately 10-20% of an ingested dose is excreted in the feces as unconjugated metabolites. Drotaverine is not completely absorbed following oral administration and its bioavailability is highly variable. After oral dose of 80 mg, the mean volume of distribution was  $193 \pm 48$  L. It is mainly eliminated via hepatic metabolism. About 67% of the drug is excreted in the faeces and about 20% in the urine.

## Indications:

Menstral Plus is indicated for:

- Reducing abdominal pains and cramps.
- Reducing pains in renal colic.
- Treatment primary dysmenorrhea.
- Treatment menorrhagia due to dysfunctional causes and presence of an IUD when other pelvic pathology has been ruled out.

## Contraindications:

- Hypersensitivity to the active substances or to any of the excipients.
- In case of inflammatory bowel and porphyria.
- History of hypersensitivity reactions related to previous NSAIDs therapy.
- Active, or history of recurrent peptic ulcer/haemorrhage related to previous NSAIDs therapy.
- Severe heart failure, hepatic failure and severe renal failure.
- During the last trimester of pregnancy.

## Warnings & Precautions:

- Caution is required in patients suffering from, or with a previous history of, asthma.
- Exercise caution in patients with renal or hepatic dysfunction.
- Caution should be exercised when treating patients suffering from epilepsy.
- It should be used with extreme caution in patients with cardiovascular problems (e.g., uncontrolled hypertension, congestive heart failure, established ischemic heart disease)
- It should be used with caution in patients with bleeding disorders.
- When GI bleeding or ulceration occurs in patients receiving Menstral Plus the treatment should be withdrawn.
- Skin reactions such as exfoliative dermatitis, Stevens-Johnson syndrome, and toxic epidermal necrolysis have been reported. Therefore, treatment should be discontinued at the first appearance of skin rash, mucosal lesions, or any signs of hypersensitivity.

## Pregnancy & Lactation:

**Pregnancy:** There is insufficient data about the safety of Menstral Plus in pregnant or breast-feeding women. Menstral Plus may be used during pregnancy only if the potential benefits justify the potential risks to the mother and fetus.

**Lactation:** Mefenamic acid may be present in breast milk. Therefore, Menstral Plus should not be used by a nursing mother.

## Drug Interactions:

**Anti-coagulants:** mefenamic acid may enhance the effects of anti-coagulants, such as warfarin.

**Selective serotonin reuptake inhibitors (SSRIs):** An increased risk of gastrointestinal bleeding has been noted.

**Other NSAIDs:** concomitant use with other NSAIDs may increase the risk of adverse effects.

**Antihypertensives and diuretics:** A reduction in antihypertensive and diuretic effect has been observed.

**Corticosteroids:** Concomitant use may increase the risk of GI ulceration or bleeding.

**Ciclosporin:** The risk of nephrotoxicity of Ciclosporin may be

increased with NSAIDs.

**Levodopa:** Drotaverine decrease the antiparkinsonian effect of levodopa.

**Methotrexate:** Methotrexate can reduce the elimination of mefenamic acid, leading to an increase in its plasma levels.

**Cardiac glycosides:** NSAIDs may exacerbate cardiac failure, reduce GFR and increase plasma cardiac glycoside levels.

## Side Effects:

Menstral Plus side effects include: gastrointestinal disturbances, heartburn, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, dry mouth, feeling thirsty, and in very rare cases skin rash and itching.

## Driving & using machines:

Some side effects such as dizziness, drowsiness, fatigue and vision disturbances may appear after taking Menstral Plus. Patients should not drive or operate machinery if these effects occur.

## Dosage & Administration:

The dosage is determined by the doctor's recommendations.

**Adults:** The usual daily dose is one tablet 2-3 times daily.

**Children over 6 years:** The usual daily dose is one tablet 1-2 times daily.

## Overdose:

**Mefenamic acid:** Symptoms include headache, nausea, vomiting, epigastric pain, gastrointestinal bleeding, rarely diarrhoea, excitation, coma, drowsiness, tinnitus, fainting, occasionally convulsions. In cases of significant poisoning acute renal failure and liver damage are possible.

**Drotaverine HCl:** No case of drotaverine overdose has been reported.

In case of overdose, the patient should be closely monitored, and managed by symptomatic and supportive care. Suggested measures include emesis and/or gastric lavage within an hour of ingestion of the overdose.

## Storage:

Keep out of reach of children. Store below 25°C.

## Packaging:

Each Menstral Plus carton box contains 10 or 20 film coated tablets in one or two blister strips.

\*A medication is a product which affects your health, and its consumption contrary to instructions is dangerous for you.  
\*Follow strictly the doctor's prescriptions, the method of use and the instructions of the pharmacist who sold the medication.  
\*The doctor and the pharmacist experts in medicine, its benefits and risks.  
\*Do not repeat the same prescription without consulting your doctor.  
KEEP THE MEDICAMENTS OUT OF REACH OF CHILDREN.  
Council of Arab Health Ministers- Union of Arab Pharmacists

Reva Pharmaceutical Industry - Syria

